# Qualifying Dissertation for the Transfer of Status

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# 1 Introduction

# 2 Literature Review

## 2.1 Foundations of Probabilistic Programming

**From Bayesian Networks to Probabilistic Programming** A central tool in Bayesian probabilistic modelling is Bayesian networks [TODO: cite], a graphical representation of a joint distribution. Formally, a Bayesian network over a certain set of variables $V$ is a directed acyclic graph over $V$, a domain $D_x$ for each variable $x \in V$, and for each variable

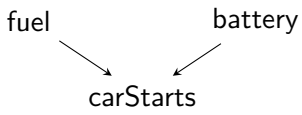



Figure 1: Graphical representaton of the car model

```
1    fuel    <- bernoulli 0.8
2    battery <- bernoulli 0.9
3    carStarts <- fuel && battery
4    condition (carStarts == False)
5    return (fuel, battery, carStarts)
```

Figure 2: Probabilistic program version of the car model, conditioned by carStarts = False

$v \in V$, a conditional distribution $P(x \mid \mathsf{Parents}(x))$. This data can be seen as a Markov factorisation of a joint distribution

$$P(x_1 ... x_n) = \prod_{x \in V} P(x \mid \mathsf{Parents}(x))$$

Bayesian networks are useful because their graphical structure encodes the conditional independencies between variables (a variable is assumed to only depend on its parents), exploited to make Bayesian inference (computing conditional distributions) more efficient. [TODO: cite again]

For instance consider the scenario where we are trying to model a car, which has fuel with probability 0.8, battery with probability 0.9, and only starts if it has both fuel and battery. Then we can model the joint distribution between fuel, battery and carStarts with the Bayesian network in fig. 1.

Probabilistic Programming languages can be seen as a compositional generalisation of Bayesian networks: they provide a compositional syntax for specifying probabilistic models and performing inference on them. Our running example, for instance, can be represented by the program in fig. 2. Like for Bayesian networks, probabilistic programs represent joint distributions (lines 1-3 of fig. 2 represent the joint distribution represented by the Bayesian network). Unlike Bayesian networks, we can also record observations like carStarts = False ('the car did not start') using the condition : $\mathbb{B} \to 1$ operation (line 4 of fig. 2), or more general 'soft' conditioning using score : $\mathbb{R}^+ \to 1$. Operationally, every (probabilistic) run of a probabilistic program carries a *weight*. Soft conditioning multiplies the weight, and hard conditioning discards any run where the boolean condition evaluates to False, i.e. scores it by 0. Clearly, condition($b$) = score(**if** $b$ **then** 1 **else** 0). [TODO: cite.] The conditional distribution that the program represents is then obtained from a weighted normalisation of the runs.

The problem of inferring the exact conditional distribution from a probabilistic program is undecidable in general [TODO: cite], and intractable to say the least. This is why inference is often solved using approximate algorithms like [TODO: cite].

**Semantics of PPLs** The semantics of probabilistic programming languages are generally given in a category **C** that 'supports probability theory' with a normalised probability monad Prob [TODO: Kock]. In the discrete case, one considers **Set** and the finitely supported distributions monad. Because **Set** is cartesian-closed, one can not only interpret first order programs, but also higher order ones like $(X \to \mathsf{Prob}(Y)) \to \mathsf{Prob}(Z)$. In the more general continuous case, one often uses categories like the category of measurable spaces **Mbl** (or subcategories thereof) with the Giry monad $G$ : **Mbl** $\to$ **Mbl** [TODO:

cite]. Because **Mbl** is famously not cartesian-closed, several works [43, 19] have developed the category of quasi-Borel spaces (QBS) as an alternative in which higher order probabilistic programming is possible. Many extensions to QBS have since been developed, such as $\omega$QBS [TODO: cite], which enables recursion, and quasi-Borel families (QBFs), which enable dependent types [TODO: cite].

Normalised probability monads only allow one to interpret sampling; interpreting conditioning (or scoring in general) will require *unnormalised* probability monads $\mathsf{Meas}$. An unnormalised probability monad should be a super-monad of the normalised counterpart. Without going into too much detail, there are many possible choices for $\mathsf{Meas}$ with different trade-offs. For instance, we can consider $\mathsf{Meas}(X) = \mathsf{Prob}(X \times \mathbb{R}^+)$, which enables general scoring using a writer effect; or indeed the subdistribution monad $\mathsf{Meas}(X) = \mathsf{Prob}(X+1)$, which only supports (hard) conditioning. Finally, in this context, Bayesian inference can be thought of as a normalisation map $\mathsf{norm} : \mathsf{Meas}(X) \to \mathsf{Prob}(X) + 1$ (e.g. [43]), where the additional $+1$ outcome is because the input distribution could be everywhere-zero.

Many PPLs exploit the monadic interface in their implementation, if not their formal analysis. To name a few:

- MonadBayes [38, 39, 40] encodes the monadic interface using Haskell's type classes, so that programs can be written independently of the choice of inference algorithm.
- LazyPPL [14] exploits Haskell's laziness for both efficient inference and inference on coinductive data like streams.
- GenJAX [6] is a vectorised probabilistic programming language built on top of Jax [TODO: cite], and has its formal analysis based on the monadic language.

**Synthetic Foundations** In parallel to probabilistic programming, *Markov categories* present a synthetic approach to probability theory. Markov categories axiomatise the categorical structure essential to probability theory without measure theory: a symmetric monoidal category (intuitively, a category of stochastic maps), along with a commutative comonoid on each object, i.e. a co-multiplication operation $\delta_A : A \to A \otimes A$ and a co-unit $\epsilon_A : A \to I$, such that $\epsilon_A$ is natural with respect to $A$. Intuitively, one thinks of $\delta_A$ as the operation of taking an $A$ and copying it, and $\epsilon_A$ as the operation of discarding the result of type $A$. [TODO: citations]. Markov categories provide a unifying account of many categories in which one can do probability theory, notably $\mathsf{FinStoch}$, the category of (finite) stochastic matries; $\mathsf{Stoch}$, the category of measurable spaces and Markov kernels; and the Kleisli categories of the probability monads that we mentioned above. For example, $\mathsf{Stoch}$ is the Kleisli category of the Giry monad on **Mbl**. The correspondence betwen Kleisli categories of affine commutative monads and a certain subclass of Markov categories coined 'representable' is studied in [TODO: Fritz, Gonda, Perrone, Rischel 2023].

Markov categories provide an elegant framework to formalise probability theory concepts, notably: deterministic morphisms, almost sure equality, conditionals, stochastic independence, Disintegration, and Bayesian inversion [TODO: citations]. More relevant to us are also analyses of graphical properties used in causal inference like $d$-seperation [TODO: cite Fritz and Klingler], which we will elaborate on later.

## 2.2 Foundations of Causal Modelling

Causal inference [30, 31], pioneered by Pearl, is a statistical toolkit that allows one to reason beyond correlation, about causation and counterfactuals. In this section we give a

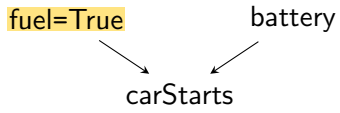



Figure 3: Car model, intervened with $\mathsf{do}(\mathsf{fuel} = \mathsf{True})$

primer of Pearl's framework for Causality. Part of the section is adapted from the term paper [46].

### 2.2.1 Pearl's Three Rungs of Causality

Pearl [31] organises causal questions about the world into three rungs:

1. Observational: if we observe that the car didn't start, does it have fuel?
2. Interventional: if we fill the car's fuel tank, will it start?
3. Counterfactual: given that the car didn't start, would it have started had we filled the tank?

As we shall see, Pearl's rungs are mathematically distinct [30], and each of these rungs require a new class of graphical models exposing more intension.

**Rung 1: Observation, Bayesian Networks** Rung 1 queries are simply Bayesian queries, which can be answered using Bayesian inference given any representation of the joint distribution, like a Bayesian network or a probabilistic program. In our example query, we wish to compute $\Pr(\neg\mathsf{fuel} \mid \neg\mathsf{carStarts})$, which we can simply produce by running inference on fig. 2, or on the corresponding Bayesian network fig. 1. We then obtain $\Pr(\neg\mathsf{fuel} \mid \neg\mathsf{carStarts}) = 5/7 \approx 0.71$.

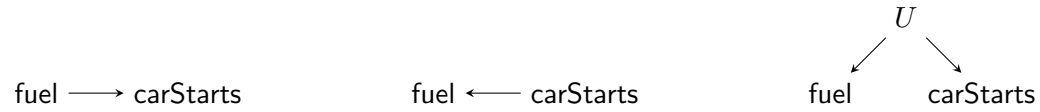
**Rung 2: Intervention, Causal Bayesian Networks** Rung 2 queries ask what happens if we *force* a variable to take a value, e.g. if we fill the car's tank. This is a question about causation and cannot be simply answered using the joint distribution.

Pearl's answer is to reinterpret Bayesian networks more intensionally: a *causal Bayesian network* (or *graphical causal model*) is a Bayesian network whose graph is represents a causal structure [30, 42]. That is, an edge $X \to Y$ in a CBN says that $X$ is a direct cause of $Y$, whereas the same edge in a BN only says that $X$ and $Y$ are correlated. Concretely, we can consider CBNs to be BNs with an additional graph-surgery operation called *intervention*: $\mathsf{do}(X = x)$ replaces the mechanism of $X$ by the constant $x$, cutting $X$ off from its parents and leaving every other mechanism unchanged.

For instance, if we reinterpret fig. 1 to be a CBN, we can answer our example query by first intervening on the model ($\mathsf{do}(\mathsf{fuel} = \mathsf{True})$), producing fig. 3, and then performing inference. We then obtain $\Pr(\mathsf{carStarts} \mid \mathsf{do}(\mathsf{fuel} = \mathsf{True})) = 0.9$.

The distinction between CBNs and BNs lies in the fact that the additional operation of intervention exposes the intensional, causal structure of the graphical model [TODO: cite]. In fig. 4, all three models represent the same joint distribution, so can be seen as equivalent as BNs, or 'rung 1 equivalent'. However, they are different as CBNs, because they clearly behave differently under intervention.

One possible intuition behind interventions is that of scientific experiments, where setting a parameter is akin to performing an intervention. [TODO: cite] So far we only




(a) Fuel causes starting (b) Starting causes fuel (c) Common cause

Figure 4: Three causal Bayesian networks over fuel and carStarts equivalent as Bayesian networks.

considered *perfect* interventions: forcefully sets a variable at a precise value. Many other types of interventions have since been considered. A few examples include:

•

[TODO: stochastic, soft interventions.]

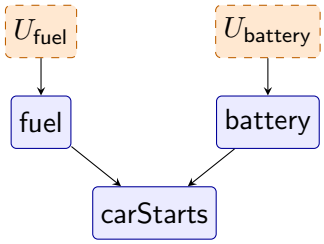
**Rung 3: Counterfactuals, Structural Causal Models** At rung 3, we consider queries that reason jointly about multiple 'worlds' at the same time. Our example query *given that the car didn't start, would it have started had we filled the tank?* explicitly reasons about two worlds: a factual world, in which we observe that the car did not in fact start, and a counterfactual world, where we fill the tank using an intervention and ask whether it would have started. Philosophically, we also want the two worlds to be very correlated: only the intervened variable should differ in the two worlds, and everything else should be kept the same. Therefore, we naturally consider defining an operation that takes a causal model and attempts to create two adequately correlated copies of it – what Pearl would call *twinning*. However, unfortunately, the data of a causal Bayesian network (e.g. the model in fig. 1) does not determine a canonical twinning [3]: there are different choices whether to share and how to share randomness between the two copies of the model.

Pearl's answer is to consider an even more intensional class of causal models called *structural causal models* [30] so that twinning is always well-defined. The following definition is adapted from [9].

**Definition 2.1** (Structural Causal Model)**.** An SCM is a tuple $\mathcal{M} = \langle \mathbf{U}, \mathbf{V}, \boldsymbol{X}, \boldsymbol{Y}, \boldsymbol{f}, \mathbb{P}_{\boldsymbol{X}} \rangle$ where

1. $\mathbf{U}$ is a finite set of exogenous variables.
2. $\mathbf{V}$ is a finite set of endogenous variables, disjoint from $\mathbf{U}$.
3. $\boldsymbol{X}$: for each exogenous variable $u \in \mathbf{U}$, its domain space $X_u \in \mathbf{Ob}\ (\mathbf{C})$
4. $\boldsymbol{Y}$: for each endogenous variable $v \in \mathbf{V}$, its domain, a measurable space $Y_v$.
5. $\boldsymbol{f}$ : for each $v \in \mathbf{V}$, a tuple $(U_v \subseteq \mathbf{U}, V_v \subseteq \mathbf{V} \backslash \{v\}, f_v : \prod_{u \in U_v} X_u \times \prod_{v' \in V_v} Y_{v'} \to Y_v)$ where $f_v$ is measurable. Intuitively these correspond to structural equations of the form $v = f_v(U_v, V_v)$.
6. $\mathbb{P}_{\boldsymbol{X}}$: a distribution over the exogenous variables.

Each acyclic SCM is a CBN. It is a special CBN that factors into an exogenous part that contains all the randomness (intuitively what is shared across the worlds), and an endogenous part that is fully deterministic and contains the causal structure (what is




$$
\begin{aligned}
U_{\text{fuel}} &\sim \text{Bern}(0.8) \\
U_{\text{battery}} &\sim \text{Bern}(0.9) \\
\text{fuel} &:= U_{\text{fuel}} \\
\text{battery} &:= U_{\text{battery}} \\
\text{carStarts} &:= \text{fuel} \wedge \text{battery}
\end{aligned}
$$

Figure 5: The car model as an SCM: graph (left) and structural equations (right). Exogenous variables are dashed (orange), endogenous variables solid (blue).

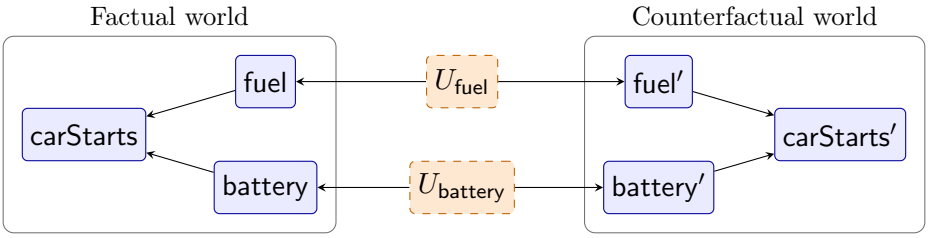



Figure 6: The twinned car SCM. The endogenous variables are copied into a factual and a counterfactual world, while the exogenous variables, and hence all the randomness, are shared between them.

copied to different worlds). Thanks to this factorisation, twinning can then be defined as the operation of creating 2 (or, in general, $n$) copies of the endogenous part and sharing the exogenous part. For example, one might define a car model SCM as fig. 5, and its twinned version becomes fig. 6. Once we have the twinned model, we can then treat it as a CBN and perform the $\mathsf{do}(\mathsf{fuel}' = \mathsf{True})$ intervention on the counterfactual copy, and condition by $\mathsf{carStarts} = \mathsf{False}$ on the factual copy, to compute the result to our query: $\Pr(\mathsf{carStarts}' \mid \neg\mathsf{carStarts}, \mathsf{do}(\mathsf{fuel}' = \mathsf{True})) = \frac{9}{14} \approx 0.64$.

However, SCMs can be equivalent as CBNs but different as SCMs. Intuitively, any CBN can be turned into an SCM by taking each of its stochastic dependencies $f : X \to \mathsf{Prob}(Y)$ and factorising it into a noise variable $n : \mathsf{Prob}(N)$ and a deterministic mechanism $f' : X \times N \to Y$, [TODO: cite reparameterisation trick]. The idea is then to set the original variables of the CBN as endogenous and the new noise variables as exogenous. Different choices of such factorisations will behave the same under interventions, but their twinnings could be different. For a concrete example, the reader may refer to e.g. [3, 30].

### 2.2.2 Topics in Causality

In this section I give a brief account of selected topics in causal inference that are relevant to the proposal.

**Causal Structures and Identifiability** In causal inference, the central object of study is often not the causal model but the graph of that model, or its causal *structure*. There are two reasons for focusing on the causal structure rather than on a particular model ([TODO: cite]). First, a fully specified model is rarely available. Secondly, the structure records the modeller's causal assumptions: an edge $X \to Y$ asserts that $Y$ *may* depend on $X$, and its absence asserts that it does not. A particular model compatible with the structure may realise fewer dependencies than the structure permits, e.g. a mechanism

may ignore one of its parents, so the structure is the more faithful record of what was assumed [42, 5].

One of the graph-centered inference tasks is *identifiability* [TODO: cite]: computing interventional distribution $\Pr(y \mid \mathsf{do}(x))$ given assumptions on the causal graph and observational distributions. If doing is is possible, we say that the causal quantity is *identifiable*. Over the years, many sufficient conditions for identifiability based on purely graphical criteria like d-separation have been developed, such as the frontdoor and backdoor criteria [TODO: cite]. These tools culminated into the do-calculus. Developed by Pearl [TODO: cite], the do-calculus is a set of three equations for rewriting interventional queries into observational ones when the causal graph satisfies some graphical criterion. [TODO: cite] proved that the do-calculus is complete for identification: a causal quantity is uniquely determined by the input observational quantities for every causal model compatible with the causal graph if and only if its expression in terms of the input observational quantities is derivable by the do-calculus.

**Equivalence of causal models** Notions of equivalence for causal models come in two families. *Graph* equivalences (e.g. Markov equivalence [45, 30]), where we consider two causal graphs to be equivalent if they encode the same conditional independencies. These equivalences underpin causal discovery (the task of discovering causal structures from data), where algorithms often recover a graph only up to its Markov equivalence class [42, 33].

*Model* equivalences determine when fully-specified causal models are equivalent. Bongers et al. [9] define a hierarchy of equivalences of structural causal models: they define two SCMs to be *observationally* equivalent if they induce the same distribution; *interventionally* equivalent if they induce the same distribution under all interventions; and *counterfactually* equivalent if they are equivalent under twinning and intervention. These notions are intuitive and have a similar flavour to contextual equivalences in programming language theory; we make the correspondence precise in [TODO: cite section]. Several more notions of equivalence sit at rung 2:

- Pearl defined how CBNs induce a family of interventional distributions [30];
- Causal spaces [29, 11] axiomatise the idea of defining the semantics of causal moedls by their interventional distributions measure-theoretically. A causal space is essentially a morphism $\prod_i (A_i + 1) \to \mathsf{Prob}(\prod_i A_i)$ in **Mbl**.
- Finally, *normalisation boxes* (local normalisation in a Markov category) generalise interventions [27, 23] and yield rung-2 equational principles for causal Bayesian networks [23, 2]; we explore it in more detail in [TODO: cite section later].

**Cyclic models** [TODO: Two interpretations]

## 2.3 Causal Probabilistic Programming Languages

### 2.3.1 Motivation

### 2.3.2 Existing causal languages and libraries

Many practical tools like DoWhy (part of the PyWhy ecosystem [35]) are libraries for manipulating SCMs as graphs and thus have limited expressiveness. DoWhy's GCM module nonetheless reaches rung 3, computing sample-level counterfactuals on fitted mechanisms [8]. Among causal PPLs proper, several stop at rung 2. Brulé's Whittemore [10], an

early embedded causal DSL, covers rung-2 identification and estimation. Pyro provides a do effect handler [7], the design that ChiRho generalises; PyMC's do performs graph surgery on the computation graph [1, 21]. Witty et al. [49] treat an intervention as a source transformation that replaces subterms, powerful (shift, variance-scaling, mechanism replacement) but non-compositional. In contrast, our languages only expose simple typed holes, which generalise to the same powerful classes of interventions for free at higher-order (**??**). Rung-3 queries can sometimes be re-encoded on such systems by hand by an identifiability argument [41].

Four systems support rung 3 natively [44, 13, 32, 25]. **OmegaC** [44] obtains rung 2 through a non-standard lazy evaluation strategy: a let-binding evaluates the bound expression $e$ to a closure $\langle \Gamma, e \rangle$ and $\mathsf{do}(x \mapsto e')$ retroactively modifies that closure $\langle \Gamma[x \mapsto e'], e \rangle$, reminiscent of dynamic binding. Rung 3 is enabled by making each program by construction an SCM-like deterministic function of an explicit exogenous noise $\omega$. OmegaC is limited in expressiveness (sampling and building random variables are separate), and only has an operational semantics. We conjecture our formalism can model OmegaC's core denotationally. **MultiVerse** [32] realises Pearl's abduction–action–prediction recipe as an importance-sampling engine, without a formal semantics. **ChiRho** [13, 12], built from effect handlers and tensor broadcasting, is both the system closest to ours, and our initial motivation. Its recent distillation into typed functional abstractions [47] bears clear similarities to $L_{\mathsf{HO}}$: intervention *points* tracked in a reader monad (our *labels* leave open how an intervention is consumed), vectorisation used in an applicative way for twinning. Two differences are key. First, our rungs 2 and 3 are decoupled: interventions never create worlds; twinning alone does. Under ChiRho's multi-world handler, by contrast, each intervention doubles the number of worlds. Second, $L_{\mathsf{HO}}$ fixes the number of worlds at twinning time and whether a variable is vectorised ($X$ or $\mathcal{E}(X)$) determines whether it is exogenous or endogenous. In contrast, ChiRho vectorises its values by default (MVal in the typed distillation [47]) and encodes an implicit sharing inference using tensor broadcasting: a random draw is shared wherever broadcasting permits, while sample sites downstream of an intervention will draw fresh noise per world. ChiRho's MVal thus allows finer control over sharing than $L_{\mathsf{HO}}$, but its relation to Pearl's twinning semantics is less clear. Finally, **probabilistic logic programming** also reaches rung 3: Kiesel et al. [25] answer counterfactual queries on ProbLog programs by a transformation proved correct against Pearl's semantics.

### 2.3.3 Summary of our POPL 2027 paper

**Motivation: Causal models as probabilistic programs, operations as program transformations**

**Contribution 1: semantic foundations of causal programming** Our first contribution is to develop a semantic foundation of causal models by taking the analogy with probabilistic programs seriously. In **??**, we reconstruct Pearl's rungs of causality as a hierarchy of simple first order probabilistic programming languages $L_1, L_2, L_3$. Each language exposes more intension than the previous one using syntactic annotations, and causal inference is performed using program transformations that consume these syntactic annotations: $L_1$ is a standard first order PPL; $L_2$ exposes typed holes named *intervention labels*, canonically of type Maybe($A$), allowing substituting to optionally perform an intervention; $L_3$ annotates each let binding with **exo** or **endo**, so that twinning can be formulated as a vectorisation transform. The same idea underlies the intervention-as-program-transformation view of Witty [48, 50], the logical account by Ibeling and

Icard [20], and the string-diagrammatic accounts of Jacobs et al. [22] and Lorenz and Tull [27].

What is new is the observation that this simple setting yields a semantic characterisation of Pearl's rungs of causality (**??**). We develop a unified account of contextual equivalences that recovers the full spectrum of causal model equivalences by varying the class of admissible contexts, e.g. Rung 3 ($L_3$) programs are Rung 3 equivalent ($\equiv_3$) if they behave the same under all twinnings and interventions; Rung 2 equivalent ($\equiv_3^{\mathsf{intv}}$) if under all interventions; Rung 1 equivalent ($\equiv_3^{\mathsf{obs}}$) if they induce the same distribution under no intervention. The subscript 3 marks that we compare $L_3$ programs throughout; the superscript marks the rung of context tested against (obs, intv, or none for full rung-3 twinning). These equivalences form a strict inclusion hierarchy $\equiv_3 \subsetneq \equiv_3^{\mathsf{intv}} \subsetneq \equiv_3^{\mathsf{obs}}$, an analogue of the causal hierarchy's non-collapse [4], i.e. programs indistinguishable at a lower rung may still differ at a higher one.

In **??** we connect the framework to the theory of SCMs, showing that $L_3$ extends SCMs conservatively: each SCM can be compiled into $L_3$, preserving the semantics of intervention and twinning (**??**). Through this compilation, we show that the hierarchy of SCM equivalences developed by Bongers et al. [9] is naturally subsumed by our program equivalences (**??**).

**Contribution 2: Typed abstractions and denotational semantics for expressive causal probabilistic programming** Our second contribution is the development of $L_{\mathsf{HO}}$, a semantically-founded, expressive, and typed language for higher-order causal probabilistic programming. $L_{\mathsf{HO}}$ has a similar programming model to ChiRho [13, 47]: it is expressive as a programming language (higher order, with control flow) and as a causal calculus (rich, higher order interventions, see **??**); we illustrate it with examples such as mediation analysis, which decomposes a causal effect into a direct path and a path through an intermediate variable (**??**). However, unlike ChiRho, it extends the first-order languages in a semantic-preserving way (**??**).

Rung 2: To manage interventions, we track intervention labels using *grading* [28, 24, 15, 16, 37], similarly to the **ImP** construction in [26] or intervention points in [47]. We define a graded reader monad $\mathcal{I}_{[\tau_1 \ldots \tau_n]}(X) \triangleq \prod_i \tau_i \to \mathsf{Meas}(X)$ graded by lists of intervention types $[\tau_1 ... \tau_n]$, where Meas is the unnormalised probability monad. A causal model of type $\mathcal{I}_{[\tau_1 \ldots \tau_n]}(X)$ is an intervenable probabilistic program with $n$ typed intervenable holes, each of type $\tau_i$, and a do intervention on the $i$th hole is simply partial application.

Rung 3: To manage counterfactuals, we first note that we will consider *$n$-world twinning*, which creates $n$ copies of the original model, because general counterfactual reasoning may require more than 2 copies. We now ask: what is the type of a model under twinning? The twinned version of the car model where only `fuel` is intervenable and `carStarts` is returned has type $\mathcal{I}_{[(\mathrm{Maybe}(\mathbb{B}))^n]}(\mathbb{B}^n)$: an intervenable computation with $n$ intervention labels (one `fuel` intervention label per world), and returning $n$ copies of `carStarts`. The trick is to make each causal model carry its behaviour under twinning, for any world count $n$. In other words the *twinnable* car model is a world-polymorphic vectorised computation of type $\forall n. \mathcal{I}_{[(\mathrm{Maybe}(\mathbb{B}))^n]}(\mathbb{B}^n)$, where $\forall$ denotes System-F-style polymorphism [36, 18]. Endogenous variables like `carStarts` become $n$-dimensional vectors, where $n$ is the number of worlds, and compose together using the applicative interface [17]. Twinning is then a simple type application. The corresponding technical setting is the functor category $[\mathbf{Bij}, \mathbf{C}]$, where $\mathbf{C}$ is the semantic model of the underlying PPL, e.g. $\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{Qbs}$ if it is continuous and higher order. Each type $A$ is informally an $n$-indexed family of $\mathbf{C}$-objects $[\![A]\!](n)$, and each function $A \to B$ is interpreted as an $n$-indexed family of morphisms

$[\![A]\!](n) \to [\![B]\!](n)$, i.e. its behaviour under $n$-world twinning. This use is similar to names in nominal sets [34].

We derive $L_{\mathsf{HO}}$ by denotational and functional programming techniques. In **??**, we develop a denotational semantics for our hierarchy of languages, which we show equivalent to the operational description (**????**). We then turn the categorical abstractions we develop into functional programming abstractions (**??**).

### 2.4 Logical, Diagrammatic, Categorical notions of Causality

#### Functorial Semantics

#### Logical characterisation of Ibeling and Icard

#### Modulating Normalisation

### 2.5 "Causality" in other fields

[TODO: say I don't fully understand yet.]

#### Concurrency

#### Quantum Computing

## 3 Project Proposal

### 3.1 Developing the field of Causal PPLs

#### 3.1.1 Putting the language into practice

#### 3.1.2 Expressivity

### 3.2 Better understanding our categorical constructions

#### 3.2.1 Relation to other constructions

#### 3.2.2 A more synthetic approach?

### 3.3 Understanding causality using a graph-centered approach

### 3.4 Understanding relationship with 'causality' as used in other fields

#### 3.4.1 Concurrency

#### 3.4.2 Higher-order processes and quantum causality

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